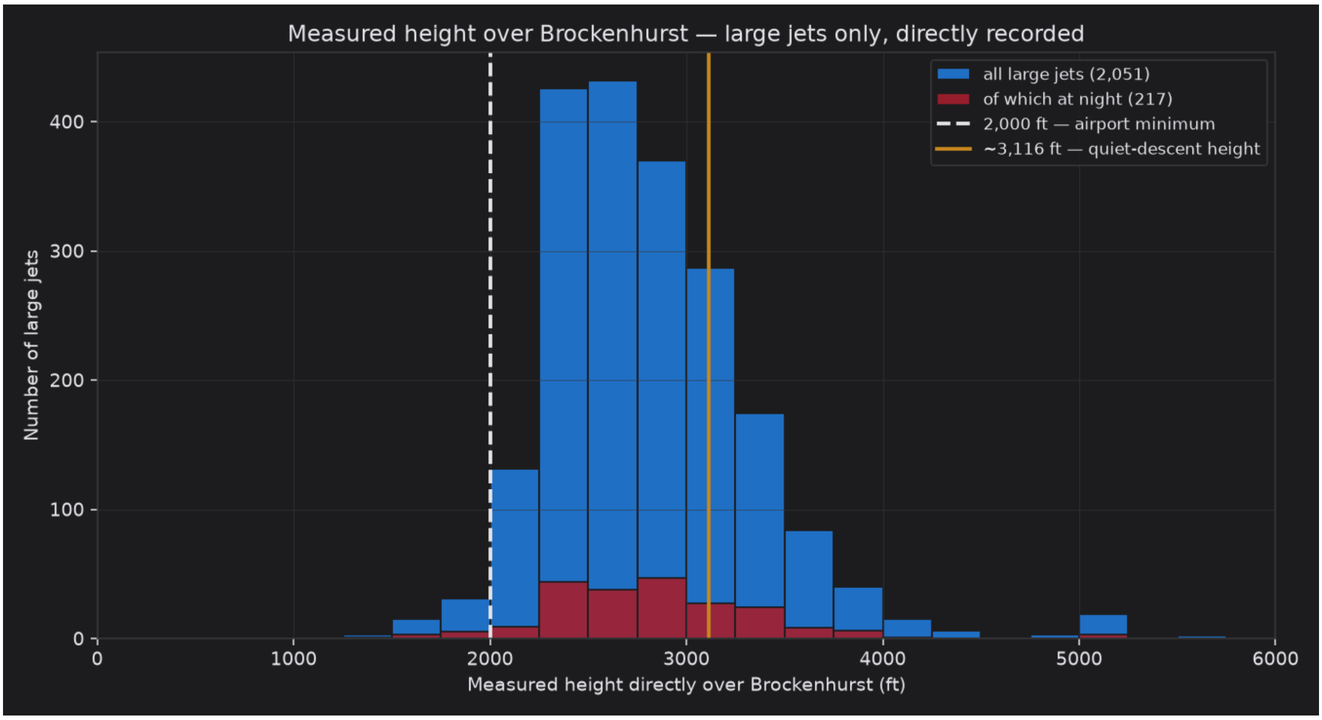
Facts-only analysis & a worked example

This companion uses **only** flights for which we have a **directly measured** height as the aircraft passed over Brockenhurst **— no estimation, no inference.** It is the ~1-in-6 subset described in `DATA_AND_DEFINITIONS.md`. Every number below is a recorded altitude from the aircraft's own broadcast.

1. Measured heights over Brockenhurst, 2023–2025

Group	Measured	Median	Below ~3,116 ft	Below 2,000 ft
All arrivals	4,938	2,500 ft	4,233 (86%)	828 (17%)
Large passenger jets	2,051	2,725 ft	1,551 (76%)	50 (2%)
Large jets at night (23:00–06:00)	217	2,775 ft	161 (74%)	9 (4%)

Read the large-jet row: of **2,051** airliners with a directly measured height over the village, **1,551** were lower than a quiet continuous descent would put them, and **50** were below the airport's own 2,000 ft minimum — all measured, none inferred.

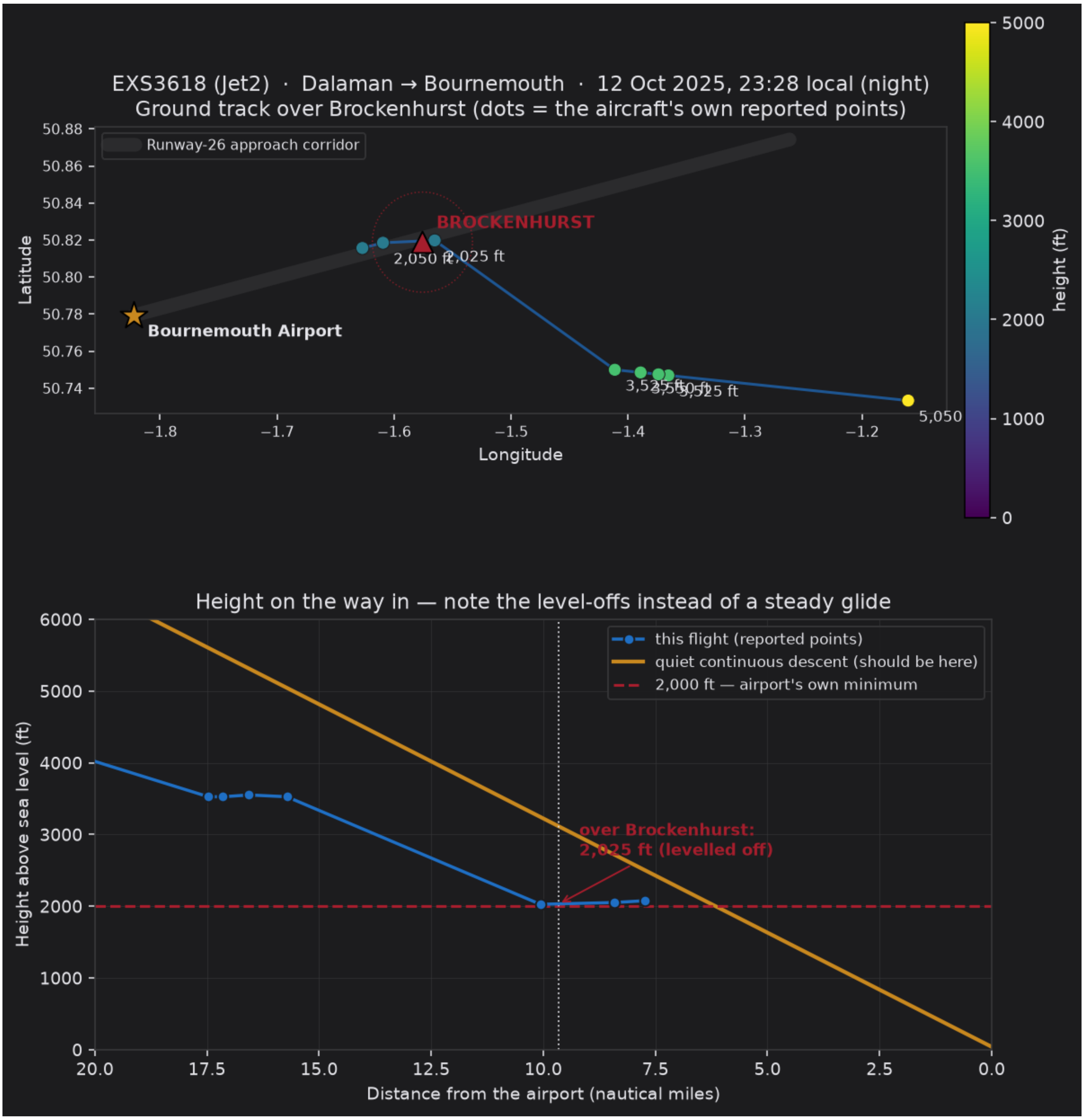


Night airliners, measured, year by year

Year	Measured	Median	Below 2,000 ft
2023	45	2,950 ft	0
2024	69	2,750 ft	2
2025	103	2,725 ft	7

2. Worked example — a recent night flight

EXS3618 (Jet2), Dalaman → Bournemouth, night of 12 October 2025. The aircraft levelled off at about **2,050 ft directly over Brockenhurst** at **23:28 local** — roughly **1,050 ft below** where a quiet continuous descent would have it, and right on the airport's own 2,000 ft minimum. Moments earlier it had also levelled at ~3,500 ft: a stepped, non-continuous descent rather than a steady glide. Both the ground track and the height profile below are built purely from the aircraft's own recorded positions.



This single flight is an illustration, not the argument on its own — the case is the consistent pattern across thousands of flights in Section 1. Method, sources and definitions: DATA_AND_DEFINITIONS.md and METHODOLOGY.md.